

Chinese: Second Language

WACE examination—2009 design brief

Stage 3

The Chinese examination comprises a written examination worth 70% of the total examination score and an oral examination worth 30% of the total examination score.

Time allowed

Reading time before commencing work: ten minutes

Working time for paper: two hours and thirty minutes

Permissible items

Standards items: pens, pencils, eraser, correction fluid, highlighter

Special items: dictionaries: one combined dictionary (Chinese/English and English/Chinese dictionary) or two separate dictionaries (one English/Chinese dictionary and one Chinese/English dictionary). No electronic dictionaries are allowed.

Additional information

Dictionaries should not contain any notes or other marks and may be inspected during the examination. The examination is presented in a combined question/answer booklet.

Section	Supporting information
Section One Listening and responding 30% of the written exam 4–8 audio texts 1–3 question(s) for shorter texts or 4–7 questions for longer texts Suggested working time: 40 minutes	Candidates are required to listen to a graded series of short texts and text types. Listening material could include announcements, dialogues. Each text is to be repeated once. Questions are asked on each text. The number of questions asked is dependent on the length and complexity of the texts. One to three question(s) for shorter texts and four to seven questions for longer texts. All questions are asked and answered in English. 20 minutes are allowed for listening and 20 minutes for completing written answers to questions.
Section Two Viewing, reading and responding 35% of the written exam 4–5 texts 1–2 question(s) for shorter texts or 3–5 questions for longer texts Suggested working time: 60 minutes	Candidates are to read 4–5 texts and answer questions to each. Questions on each text are written and answered in English. Text types could include diary entries, stories, dialogues, accounts, letters, essays, posters and advertisements.
Section Three Writing 35% of the written exam Part A: Short text Three topics, answer one question Part B: Longer text One question from a choice of three Suggested working time: 50 minutes	Part A: Candidates are required to write one text of approximately 60 characters. Part B: Candidates write one text of approximately 150 characters. Text types required of candidates include letters, emails, narrative accounts, personal accounts, diary entries and reviews.